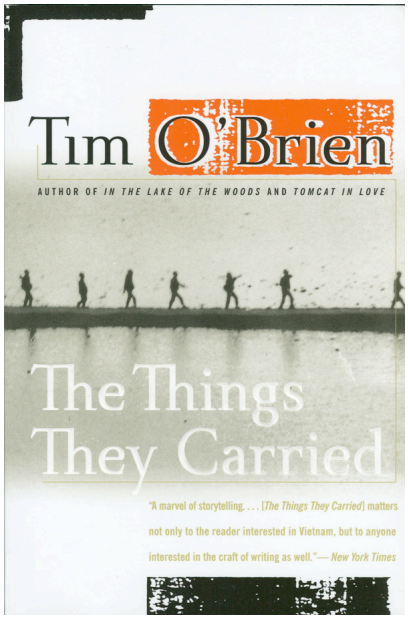
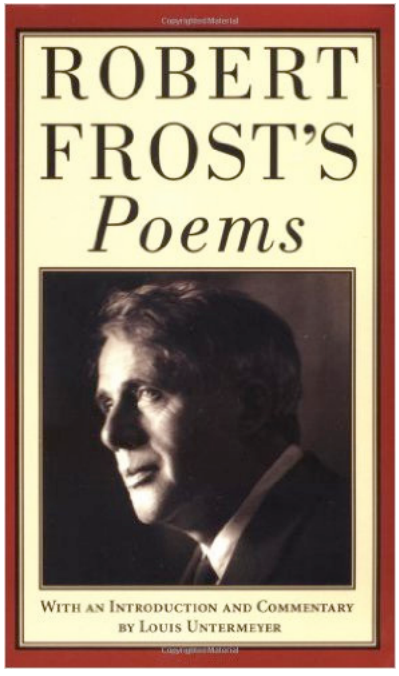
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

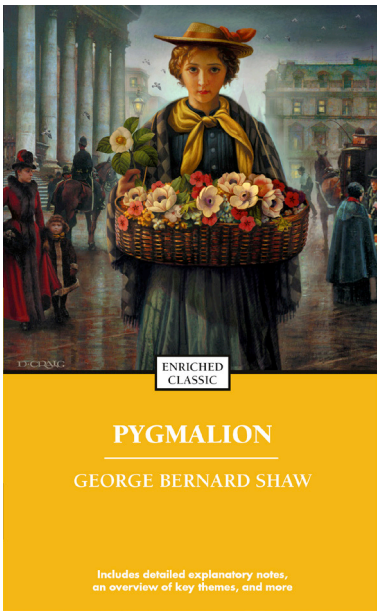
Making a World of Difference

# Literary Criticism

## District 2 • 2016




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YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO!

# University Interscholastic League
# Literary Criticism Contest • District 2 • 2016

**Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History** **30 items (1 point each)**

1. Any expression so often used that its freshness and clarity have worn off is called a(n)
   A) allusion.
   B) cliché.
   C) pun.
   D) quibble.
   E) stereotype.

2. A name applied to the belief–widely held in Western Europe during the nineteenth century–that society has an innate tendency toward improvement and that the tendency can be furthered by conscious human effort is
   A) archaism.
   B) determinism.
   C) expressionism.
   D) meliorism.
   E) sentimentalism.

3. The period in English literature between the death of Victoria and the beginning of World War I is the
   A) Augustan Age.
   B) Caroline Age.
   C) Edwardian Age.
   D) Jacobean Age.
   E) Victorian Age.

4. A section or division of a long poem, originally, a section of a narrative poem of such length as to be sung by a minstrel in one singing is known as a(n)
   A) aubade.
   B) ballad.
   C) canto.
   D) monody.
   E) verset.

5. The term that embodies the application of principles of scientific determinism in literature, which, in turn, characterizes a literary movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, is
   A) Darwinism.
   B) Erastianism.
   C) Naturalism.
   D) Objectivism.
   E) Surrealism.

6. **Not** among terms originally or exclusively used in the film industry is
   A) cross-cutting.
   B) deep focus.
   C) rough cut.
   D) sound-over.
   E) unities.

7. A term applied to women of pronounced intellectual interests that gained currency after 1750 and whose "membership" has included Elizabeth Montagu and Horace Walpole, among others, is
   A) Bloomsbury Group.
   B) Bluestockings.
   C) Kit-Cat Club.
   D) Literary Club.
   E) Postmodernist.

8. The recipient of the 1965 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for the short familial play *The Subject Was Roses* is
   A) Edward Albee.
   B) Marc Connelly.
   C) Owen Davis.
   D) Frank D. Gilroy.
   E) William Inge.

9. The figure of speech that makes a brief reference to a historical, literary, or cultural figure, event, or object is
   A) allusion.
   B) apostrophe.
   C) epiphany.
   D) tableau.
   E) vignette.

10. Three times a Pulitzer Prize finalist, the Serbian American imagist poet who received the 1990 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his collection entitled *The World Doesn't End* is
   A) John Berryman.
   B) Robert Hass.
   C) Ted Kooser.
   D) Howard Nemerov.
   E) Charles Simic.

11. To expurgate a piece of writing by omitting material considered offensive or indecorous, especially to female modesty, as demonstrated in some early nineteenth-century editions of Shakespeare's plays, is to

A) abridge.
B) bowdlerize.
C) double bill.
D) quibble.
E) truncate.

12. The Peruvian writer, university professor, and one-time presidential candidate who received the 2010 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) José Echegaray.
B) Mario Vargas Llosa.
C) Gabriel García Márquez.
D) Gabriela Mistral.
E) José Saramago.

13. **Not** having an eponymic origin, an origin based on the name of a real or fictional character, is the literary term

A) Byronism.
B) euphemism.
C) grundyism.
D) malapropism.
E) spoonerism.

14. The twentieth-century American "Genius Award" recipient and author of *V*, *The Crying of Lot 49*, *Gravity's Rainbow*, *Vineland*, *Mason and Dixon*, and *Against the Day* is

A) William Faulkner.
B) Cormac McCarthy.
C) Larry McMurtry.
D) Walker Percy.
E) Thomas Pynchon.

15. A chronicle, usually autobiographical, presenting the life story of a rascal of low degree engaged in menial tasks and making his living more through his wit than his industry, and tending to be episodic and structureless, is known as a(n)

A) epistolary novel.
B) novel of character.
C) novel of manners.
D) novel of soil.
E) picaresque novel.

16. The term that means literally a manifestation or showing-forth that designates an event in which the essential nature of something—a person, a situation, an object—is suddenly perceived is

A) alienation effect.
B) apostrophe.
C) epiphany.
D) nekuia.
E) zeugma.

17. The Elizabethan author of *The Shepheardes Calendar*, *The Fairie Queene*, *Amoretti*, and *Epithalamion* is

A) Ben Jonson.
B) Thomas Kyd.
C) Christopher Marlowe.
D) William Shakespeare.
E) Edward Spenser.

18. The specific geographic and scenic qualities of the physical setting in which a story's action takes place is its

A) locale.
B) milieu.
C) revue.
D) setting.
E) topos.

19. The nineteenth-century American short story author who wrote *The Narrative of Arthur Gordon Pym of Nantucket*, *Tales of the Grotesque and Arabesque*, and *Eureka: A Prose Poem* is

A) Ambrose Bierce.
B) Nathaniel Hawthorne.
C) Washington Irving.
D) Edgar Allan Poe.
E) Mark Twain.

20. A Japanese poetic form that, in cultural transliteration, features, usually, seventeen syllables arranged in lines of five, seven, and five and relies on humor or satire rather than nature or the seasons is the

A) haiku.
B) lai.
C) senryu.
D) tanka.
E) triolet.

21. The term literally meaning mask that is widely used to refer to a "second self" created by an author and through whom a narrative is told is

A) allonym.
B) doppelgänger.
C) eponym.
D) persona.
E) putative author.

22. The followers of England's Charles I who composed lighthearted poems thematically concerned with war, love, chivalry, and loyalty to the king, and among whose numbers are Thomas Carew, Richard Lovelace, and Sir John Suckling, are known as

A) Cavalier Lyricists.
B) the Fleshly School of Poetry.
C) Goliardic Poets.
D) the Lake Poets.
E) the Pre-Raphaelites.

23. The overweening pride or insolence that results in the misfortune of the protagonist of a tragedy is called

A) catharsis.
B) hamartia.
C) hubris.
D) nemesis.
E) peripety.

24. The Bengali American recipient of both the 2000 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction and the Hemingway Foundation/PEN Award for her short story collection *Interpreter of Maladies* is

A) Indira Goswami.
B) Jhumpa Lahiri.
C) Sudha Murthy.
D) Arundhati Roy.
E) Indu Sundaresan.

25. The group of American writers, including Ida Tarbell, Lincoln Steffens, and Upton Sinclair, who between 1902 and 1911 worked to expose the dishonest methods and unscrupulous motives in big business and in city, state, and national government is

A) the Agrarians.
B) The Fugitives.
C) the Hartford Wits.
D) the Lost Generation.
E) the Muckrakers.

26. **Not** considered to be one of the chief elements or genres contributing to the development of Elizabethan drama is/are

A) medieval drama.
B) morality plays.
C) Restoration drama.
D) Roman comedies.
E) Roman revenge tragedies.

27. The group of American poets who flourished between 1950 and 1970, the members distinguished by urbanity, wit, learning, spontaneity, and exuberance and having an interest in modern painting, French culture, and jazz, is the

A) Fireside Poets.
B) Hartford Wits.
C) Knickerbocker Group.
D) Muckrakers.
E) New York School.

28. In prosody, the emphasis given to a syllable in articulation is called a(n)

A) accent.
B) breve.
C) caesura.
D) diastole.
E) expletive.

29. The nineteenth-century British novelist who wrote *Pride and Prejudice*, *Emma*, *Sense and Sensibility*, *Persuasion*, *Northanger Abbey*, *Mansfield Park*, and *Lady Susan* is

A) Jane Austen.
B) Charlotte Brontë.
C) Emily Brontë.
D) Fanny Burney.
E) George Eliot.

30. A type of word formed by telescoping two words into one, as the making of "squarson" from "squire" and "parson," "smog" from "smoke" and "fog," and "muppet" from "marionette" and "puppet," is a(n)

A) allelograph.
B) correption.
C) fractal.
D) portmanteau word.
E) synaeresis.

**Part 2: The UIL Reading List** **20 items (2 points each)**

**Items 31-36 are associated with George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*.**

**Items 37-42 are associated with Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*.**

**Items 43-50 are associated with Robert Frost's poetry (selected).**

31. In the opening scene of George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*, the Note Taker's listing of "Cheltenham, Harrow, Cambridge, and India" describes
    A) Alfred Doolittle.
    B) Eliza Doolittle.
    C) Freddy Eynsford Hill.
    D) Professor Higgins.
    E) Colonel Pickering.

32. The bells that he hears while waiting in the portico of Inigo Jones's St. Paul's church remind Higgins that he should
    A) answer his mother's phone call.
    B) appreciate silence more.
    C) be charitable.
    D) get Tiny Tim a Christmas goose.
    E) order a drink before the pubs close.

33. The first time that Alfred Doolittle sees his daughter Eliza after the initial stage of her metamorphosis, she appears as a
    A) countess.
    B) daughter of an American philanthropist.
    C) flower girl.
    D) Hungarian princess.
    E) Japanese lady.

34. On the pavement outside Eliza's second-floor room at the Wimpole Street laboratory is where
    A) Alfred Doolittle drops the five-pound note.
    B) Alfred Doolittle delivers Eliza's luggage.
    C) Eliza hails a cab after Higgins throws coins to her.
    D) Freddy spends most of his nights.
    E) Mrs. Pearce puts Eliza's clothes for the rubbish man.

35. In Mrs. Higgins's drawing room, the very reproachful admonishment, "*I* should have thrown the fire-irons at you," is delivered by
    A) Miss Doolittle to Mr. Doolittle.
    B) Mr. Doolittle to one of the "Mrs." Doolittles.
    C) Mrs. Higgins to Henry Higgins.
    D) Mrs. Pearce to Miss Doolittle.
    E) Mrs. Pearce to Professor Higgins.

36. Professor Higgins writes a letter declaring that the "most original [to his knowledge] moralist at present in England" is
    A) Alfred Doolittle.
    B) Henry Higgins.
    C) Colonel Pickering.
    D) George Bernard Shaw.
    E) Ezra D. Wannafeller.

37. In Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*, the narrator enumerates the things the individual soldiers carry, and he notes that they all carry
    A) Bibles.
    B) cell phones.
    C) ghosts.
    D) guilt.
    E) passports.

38. His hometown "had no memory, therefore no guilt. [It] could not talk and would not listen [. . .] and did not care to know" about the war, according to
    A) Norman Bowker.
    B) Jimmy Cross.
    C) Henry Dobbins.
    D) Ted Lavender.
    E) Mitchell Sanders.

39. One significant and memorable day in 1956, the fourth graders Tim O'Brien and Nick Veenhof
    A) play hooky and goes fishing.
    B) predict their own deaths in war.
    C) ski through the backwoods to the lake.
    D) sneak into a movie theater.
    E) walk Linda home.

40. "The man's self-control was amazing. He never pried" and "[he] understood that words were insufficient" describes
    A) Elroy Berdahl.
    B) Henry Dobbins.
    C) Rat Kiley.
    D) Kiowa.
    E) O'Brien's father.

41. Mitchell Sanders addresses an envelope to his draft board in Ohio and fills it with (a)

A) body lice.
B) Dear John letters.
C) Mary Anne's necklace.
D) ripped-up draft notification.
E) used sutures.

42. Dobbins remarks to Kiowa one morning, "You know, after the war maybe I'll join up with" the

A) Baptist Apaches in Oklahoma.
B) Buddhist monks.
C) draft dodgers in Canada.
D) Veterans Against War.
E) Viet Cong guerrillas.

**Items 43-46 refer to Robert Frost's**

**Ghost House**

I dwell in a lonely house I know
That vanished many a summer ago,
  And left no trace but the cellar walls,
  And a cellar in which the daylight falls,
And the purple-stemmed wild raspberries grow.

O'er ruined fences the grape-vines shield
The woods come back to the mowing field;
  The orchard tree has grown one copse
  Of new wood and old where the woodpecker chops;
The footpath down to the well is healed.

I dwell with a strangely aching heart
In that vanished abode there far apart
  On that disused and forgotten road
  That has no dust-bath now for the toad.
Night comes; the black bats tumble and dart;

The whippoorwill is coming to shout
And hush and cluck and flutter about:
  I hear him begin far enough away
  Full many a time to say his say
Before he arrives to say it out.

It is under the small, dim, summer star.
I know not who these mute folk are
  Who share the unlit place with me—
  Those stones out under the low-limbed tree
Doubtless bear names that the mosses mar.

They are tireless folk, but slow and sad,
Though two, close-keeping, are lass and lad,—
  With none among them that ever sings,
  And yet, in view of how many things,
As sweet companions as might be had.

43. The description of the whippoorwill in lines 16-20 of Frost's "Ghost House" depends on

A) cacaphony.
B) heteroglossia.
C) nonce words.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) sigmatism.

44. The continuation of syntax and meaning from the third into the fourth stanza is an instance of

A) boustrophedon.
B) enjambment.
C) metathesis.
D) parenthesis.
E) truncation.

45. The species of repetition found in lines 19-20 in which different senses of the word *say* are woven through the description is called

A) anaphora.
B) merism.
C) pleonasm.
D) ploce.
E) tautology.

46. Line 25 features both

A) alliteration and assonance.
B) alliteration and sigmatism.
C) consonance and assonance.
D) dissonance and resonance.
E) sigmatism and zeugma.

**Items 47-50 refer to Robert Frost's**

**Acquainted with the Night**

I have been one acquainted with the night.
I have walked out in rain—and back in rain.
I have outwalked the furthest city light.

I have looked down the saddest city lane.
I have passed by the watchman on his beat
And dropped my eyes, unwilling to explain.

I have stood still and stopped the sound of feet
When far away an interrupted cry
Came over houses from another street,

But not to call me back or say good-bye;
And further still at an unearthly height,
One luminary clock against the sky

Proclaimed the time was neither wrong nor right.
I have been one acquainted with the night.

47. The form of Frost's "Acquainted with the Night" is the

A) envoy.
B) fourteener.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) pantoum.
E) *terza rima*.

48. The repetition of the same beginning phrases in the first five lines of the poem is called

A) anaphora.
B) epanalepsis.
C) polyptoton.
D) polysyndeton.
E) sfumato.

49. The tone of Frost's poem is

A) cynical.
B) indignant.
C) jovial.
D) melancholic.
E) sardonic.

50. The "one luminary clock against the sky" (line 12) is the

A) moon.
B) North Star.
C) planet Alderaan.
D) sidereal zodiac.
E) sun.

## Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
**15 items (2 points each)**

**Items 51-56 refer to Amy Lowell's**

**To John Keats**

Great master! Boyish, sympathetic man!
Whose orbed and ripened genius lightly hung
From life's slim, twisted tendril and there swung
In crimson-sphered completeness; guardian
Of crystal portals through whose openings fan
The spiced winds which blew when earth was young,
Scattering wreaths of stars, as Jove once flung
A golden shower from heights cerulean.
Crumbled before thy majesty we bow.
Forget thy empurpled state, thy panoply
Of greatness, and be merciful and near;
A youth who trudged the highroad we tread now
Singing the miles behind him; so may we
Faint throbbings of thy music overhear.

51. The form of Amy Lowell's fourteen-line "To John Keats" is the

A) Anglo-Italian sonnet.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. The sense **not** invoked by the imagery that threads through Lowell's poem is

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

53. The tone and purpose of the sonnet borders on

A) epiphanic.
B) farcical.
C) gnomic.
D) hagiographic.
E) melioristic.

54. The speaker's addressing John Keats, who has been long dead, as if he were present is called

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) harangue.
D) rhetorical accent.
E) soliloquy.

55. The "power of language to cast visual images on the imagination" as exhibited in Lowell's sonnet is, in Ezra Pound's coinage,

A) epopoeia.
B) melopoeia.
C) mythopoeia.
D) phanopoeia.
E) prosopopoeia.

56. The comparison of Keats as "guardian / Of crystal portals" to Jove who "once flung / A golden shower from the [blue] heights" (lines 4-8) depends on (a/an)

A) allusion and a simile.
B) litotes and hyperbole.
C) kenning and a paradox.
D) personification and imagery.
E) zeugma and reification.

**Items 57-60 refer to Emily Dickinson's**

**[The moon was but a chin of gold]**

The moon was but a chin of gold
A night or two ago,
And now she turns her perfect face
Upon the world below.

Her forehead is of amplest blond;
Her cheek like beryl hewn;
Her eye unto the summer dew
The likest I have known.

Her lips of amber never part;
But what must be the smile
Upon her friend she could confer
Were such her silver will!

And what a privilege to be
But the remotest star!
For certainty her way might pass
Beside your twinkling door.

Her bonnet is the firmament,
The universe her shoe,
The stars the trinkets at her belt,
Her dimities* of blue.

*clothing

57. Dickinson's endowing the moon with human form in "[The moon was but a chin of gold]" constitutes

A) affective fallacy.
B) apostrophe.
C) pathetic fallacy.
D) personification.
E) zoomorphism.

58. The type of slant rhyme found in the *hewn-known* (lines 6 & 8) and the *star-door* (14 & 16) combinations is

A) assonance.
B) concordance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

59. The metaphor that runs throughout Dickinson's poem and ensures the poem's effectiveness constitutes its

A) aesthetic distance.
B) controlling image.
C) dead metaphor.
D) motif.
E) objective correlative.

60. The inversion characterizing lines 7-8 encompasses an effective

A) analogue.
B) kenning.
C) metaphor.
D) metonymy.
E) simile.

**Items 61-63 refer to Wendell Berry's**

**The Vacation**

Once there was a man who filmed his vacation.
He went flying down the river in his boat
with his video camera to his eye, making
a moving picture of the moving river
upon which his sleek boat moved swiftly
toward the end of his vacation. He showed
his vacation to his camera, which pictured it,
preserving it forever: the river, the trees,
the sky, the light, the bow of his rushing boat
behind which he stood with his camera
preserving his vacation even as he was having it
so that after he had had it he would still
have it. It would be there. With a flick
of a switch, there it would be. But he
would not be in it. He would never be in it.

61. The overall effect of Wendell Berry's "The Vacation" depends on (a)

A) ambiguity.
B) conceit.
C) hyperbole.
D) irony.
E) mimesis.

62. The poem's lack of rhyme and the indeterminate meter places it among poetry known as

A) biblical verse.
B) blank verse.
C) free verse.
D) heroic verse.
E) shaped verse.

63. The thematic concern of Wendell Berry's fifteen-line lyric poem focuses on

A) apostrophizing a camera.
B) enjoying vacations years from now.
C) making adventure films.
D) paying quality attention while being in the world.
E) suffering remorse for not having gone digital.

**Items 64-65 refer to Jo-Anne McLaughlin-Carruth's**

**Night-Court at Solomon's**

Say it's Mother — at his wrists.
Death — no question, pulls
who has him — he's Hers
by the ankles — who claims
and won't — the Other
let go, while — let go, while
the Other — and won't
who claims — by the ankles
he's Hers — who has him
no question, pulls — Death
at his wrists — Say it's Mother

64. The title of McLaughlin-Carruth's poem sets up a(n)
A) biblical apportionment.
B) chiaroscuristic rebus.
C) inversion of the original story.
D) misremembered didactic anecdote.
E) typographical error.

65. "Night-Court at Solomon's" is an example of a(n)
A) acrostic.
B) *carmen figuratum*.
C) clerihew.
D) rebus.
E) square poem.

**Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)**

**Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.**

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

---

Read Robert Frost's "Riders," and address the controlling image upon which Frost's poem depends.

**Riders**

The surest thing there is is we are riders,
And though none too successful at it, guiders,
Through everything presented, land and tide
And now the very air, of what we ride.

What is this talked-of mystery of birth
But being mounted bareback on the earth?
We can just see the infant up astride,
His small fist buried in the bushy hide.

There is our wildest mount—a headless horse.
But though it runs unbridled off its course,
And all our blandishments* would seem defied,
We have ideas yet that we haven't tried.

* **flattering persuasion**

**KEY**

## UIL Literary Criticism
## District 2 • 2016

*line arrows up* ➔

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | B | 92 |
| 2. | D | 291 |
| 3. | C | 165 |
| 4. | C | 73 |
| 5. | C | 315 |
| 6. | E | 490 |
| 7. | B | 62 |
| 8. | D | 608 |
| 9. | A | 14 |
| 10. | E | 605 |
| 11. | B | 66 |
| 12. | B | 691 |
| 13. | B | 186 |
| 14. | E | 588 |
| 15. | E | 362 |
| 16. | C | 178 |
| 17. | E | 532 |
| 18. | A | 277 |
| 19. | D | 559 |
| 20. | C | 438 |
| 21. | D | 361 |
| 22. | A | 78 |
| 23. | C | 239 |
| 24. | B | 603 |
| 25. | E | 309 |
| 26. | C | 408 |
| 27. | E | 324 |
| 28. | A | 3 |
| 29. | A | 554 |
| 30. | D | 374 |
| 31. | E | 19 |
| 32. | C | 24 |
| 33. | E | 60 |
| 34. | D | 103 |
| 35. | C | 115 |
| 36. | A | 111 |
| 37. | C | 9 |
| 38. | A | 111 |
| 39. | E | 223 |
| 40. | A | 49 |
| 41. | A | 30 |
| 42. | B | 114 |
| 43. | D | 337 |
| 44. | B | 174 |
| 45. | D | 366 |
| 46. | B | |
| 47. | E | 475 |
| 48. | A | 24 |
| 49. | D | |
| 50. | A | |
| 51. | B | 498 |
| 52. | B | |
| 53. | D | 235 |
| 54. | A | 37 |
| 55. | D | 361 |
| 56. | A | |
| 57. | D | 361 |
| 58. | C | 107 |
| 59. | B | 108 |
| 60. | E | 445 |
| 61. | D | 259 |
| 62. | C | 209 |
| 63. | D | |
| 64. | C | |
| 65. | B | 74 |

FOLD
along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

***Please*** note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

**DO NOT**
mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

the Simon & Schuster *Pygmalion*,

the Mariner-Houghton *The Things They Carried*,

and to Untermeyer's Frost collection.

**Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay**

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

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**Critical Notes on Robert Frost's "Riders"**

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the controlling image in Robert Frost's poem "Riders" include

alliteration,
ambiguity,
controlling image,
feminine rhyme,
iambic pentameter,
imagery,
masculine rhyme,
metaphor,
paradox,
quatrain,
rhetorical question,
synecdoche,
theme, and
tone.

The controlling image of Frost's "Riders," that we are riders on a journey through life, should give the young writer little trouble.

The earth as horse and the individual as bareback rider constitute the foundation-metaphor, the controlling image, that is anchored in the displacing of the "mystery" of birth (line 5) through the imagery of the infant taking naturally to the challenge that is life/living/perhaps, exploring: "His small fist buried in the bushy hide" (line 8). There is no mystery: we are here to ride, even if the mount "runs unbridled off its course" (line 10).

The student might recognize the range of potential experience—"land and tide / And now the very air" (lines 3-4), a phrasing that also suggests the opportunities that are offered to us as riders and as guiders (line 2): both as individuals and as humankind through the course of history into the age of flight (the ***now*** in line 4's "And now the very air").

The connotations associated with the metaphorical imagery "headless horse" and "run[ning] off its course" (lines 9-10) reinforce the "defied blandishments" of line 11: we might be encouraged as riders, or we might, as guiders, encourage others. Not everything works out (lines 9-11), and the opportunities continue: "We have ideas yet that we haven't tried" (line 12).

The contestant who is conscious of Frost's inclination to match, in some way, a poem's subject or its theme with the characteristics of poetic expression might point to the implied balance and stability of the rhymed iambic pentameter against the "seeming" (line 11) wild ride that is our living on this earth.

# ANSWER SHEET

## UIL Literary Criticism
## District 1 • 2016

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
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Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

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**Part 3**

_____
**contestant number**

_____
**SCORE**

***Please*** note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

**FIRST GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

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*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

**SECOND GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

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*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

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initials

**THIRD GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

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*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials